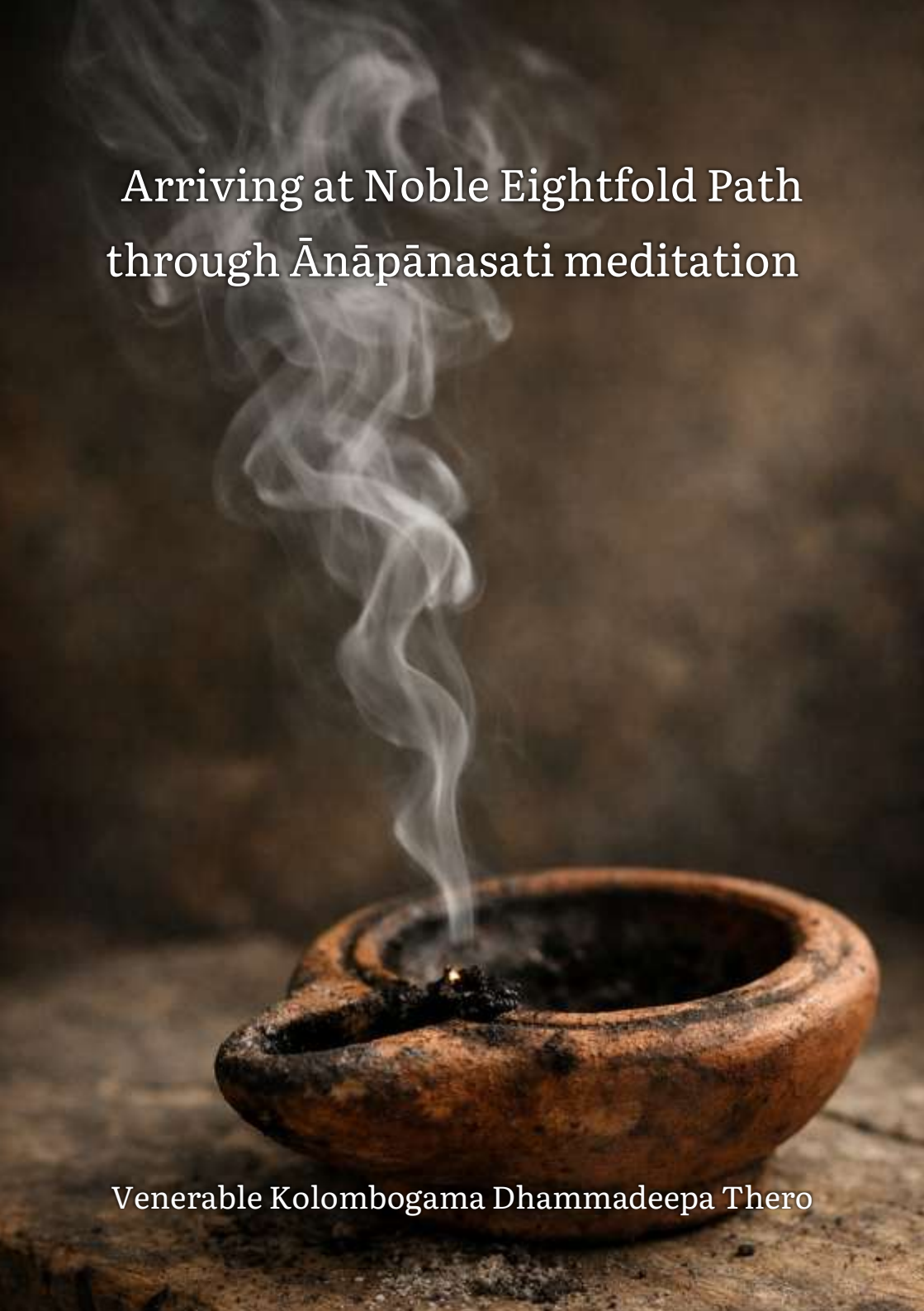
Arriving at Noble Eightfold Path through Ānāpānasati meditation



Venerable Kolombogama Dhammadeepa Thero

Arriving at Noble Eightfold Path through Ānāpānasati Meditation

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A Gift of Dhamma,
dedicated to the faithful ones
who strive for liberation
from the suffering of Saṃsāra

By Venerable Kolombogama Dhammadeepa Thero

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Sharing of Merit

May the meritorious power generated by this wholesome act of Dhamma-dāna become a supporting resource for the attainment of the ultimately peaceful Nibbāna,
for our respectable teacher, Most Venerable Asgiriwalapola Sudassī Mahāthero, who guided us from the very beginning with advice and instructions;
for all the kalyanamitta venerables and devotees who assisted in various ways.

Arriving at Noble Eightfold Path through Ānāpānasati Meditation

Samantā cakkavālesu – atthāgacchantu devatā
Saddhammaṃ munirājassa – suṇantu sagga mokkhadhaṃ

May the deities from all around the universes assemble here for listening to the True Dhamma of the King of Sages, which leads to heaven and liberation.

Dhammassavaṇa kālo ayaṃ bhadantā
Dhammassavaṇa kālo ayaṃ bhadantā
Dhammassavaṇa kālo ayaṃ bhadantā

This is the excellent time for hearing the Dhamma ///

Namo tassa bhagavato arahato sammā sambuddhassa ///

I pay homage to that Fortunate One, the Worthy One, the Perfectly Self-Enlightened One. May my homage be offered!

Idha, bhikkhave, bhikkhu araññagato vā rukkhamūlagato vā suññāgāragato vā nisīdati pallaṅkaṃ ābhujitvā ujuṃ kāyaṃ paṇidhāya parimukhaṃ satiṃ upaṭṭhapetvā.

So satova assasati, satova passasati.

Dīghaṃ vā assasanto 'dīghaṃ assasāmī'ti pajānāti. Dīghaṃ vā passasanto 'dīghaṃ passasāmī'ti pajānāti.
Rassaṃ vā assasanto 'rassaṃ assasāmī'ti pajānāti. Rassaṃ vā passasanto 'rassaṃ passasāmī'ti pajānāti.

'Sabbakāya paṭisaṃvedī assasissāmī'ti sikkhati. 'Sabbakāya paṭisaṃvedī passasissāmī'ti sikkhati.
'Passambhayaṃ kāyasaṅkhāraṃ assasissāmī'ti sikkhati. 'Passambhayaṃ kāyasaṅkhāraṃ passasissāmī'ti sikkhati.

"Here, in this sasana, a monk, gone to the forest, or to the root of a tree, or to an empty hut, sits down; having folded his legs crosswise, straightened his body, and established mindfulness in parimukha.

With that mindfulness, one breathes. With that mindfulness, one breathes out.

Breathing in long, he knows: 'I breathe in long'; or breathing out long, he knows: 'I breathe out long.'
Breathing in short, he knows: 'I breathe in short'; or breathing out short, he knows: 'I breathe out short.'

'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself. 'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains himself.
'Calming the bodily formation, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself. 'Calming the bodily formation, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains himself."

Venerable Sangha residing in the monastery, the most respectable Sangha fathers, headed by the Venerable Chief Incumbent! With your permission from the venerable, worshipful, great Sangha jewel, the sons of the Lord Buddha!

Devout Buddhists endowed with compassion, faith and wisdom,

One should be liberated from this Saṃsāra very quickly

Today, in the evening session of our meditation program, we are about to begin this Dhamma sermon. So, those who have listened well about the Catursaṃvara Sīla (the fourfold purified morality) and are working by repeatedly practicing the Dhamma they heard, upon repeatedly reflecting and contemplating the Saṃsāra and the nature of Saṃsāra, understanding the Saṃsāra and the nature of Saṃsāra within the Dhamma, the mindfulness and wisdom arises within them: "One should be liberated from this dreadful, painful, fearful Saṃsāra very quickly." Empowered by that mindfulness and wisdom, these meritorious individuals, endowed with supreme faith, work within this Buddha Sasana (dispensation of the lord buddha), having practiced the four Satipaṭṭhāna (the four foundations of mindfulness) for a long time.

Dwelling within Satipaṭṭhāna

So, for these meritorious individuals, we have already explained how to practice several meditation themes from the Satipaṭṭhāna Sutta discourse. As the primary meditation themes, they are practicing the Ānāpānasati meditation theme and the Dhātu Manasikāra (contemplation of elements) meditation theme. Furthermore, along with these meditation themes, they are practicing the objects related to the Iriyāpatha Pabbaya (the postures) and the Sampajāna Pabbaya (clear comprehension) as meditation themes at every possible opportunity, '***Viharati***' dwelling within the Satipaṭṭhāna.
So, we taught how to investigate pain, taking an approach to Vedanānupassanā (contemplation of feelings) in the morning. Also, I hope to teach some parts related to Dhammānupassanā (contemplation of dhamma phenomena) to these devotees in future sermons.

Practice this Dhamma according to your own strength

So, meritorious devotees, these meritorious individuals are now practicing their meditation as expounded by the Blessed Lord Buddha, studying the Mahā Satipaṭṭhāna Sutta, understanding its meaning, and proceeding accordingly. For this purpose, we have even provided those books to them free of charge. And we are explaining the meanings to the best of our ability. Proceeding accordingly, these meritorious individuals are practicing this Dhamma according to their own strength. Today's sermon is intended to be one that further elaborates on the previously given sermons. We hope to explain a multitude of points regarding Ānāpānasati meditation today. And beforehand, we also hope to explain a few points regarding the application of effort (vīriya).

May it be solely for the realization of Dhamma

Thus, meritorious devotees, is the forward progression of today's sermon. So, for all these meritorious ones and for everyone in the world including devas and brahmas, may this Dhamma sermon be a cause solely for the realization of Dhamma! With this aspiration, we begin today's Dhamma sermon.

It's not going to work out by applying effort in the same way

Now, you, taking Ānāpānasati and Dhātu Manasikāra as the primary meditation themes, how should work by well-practicing the Iriyāpatha, Sampajāna Pabbaya, and Vedanānupassanā, we explained in previous sermons. When the mind is directed towards Ānāpānasati meditation, when the mind is directed towards Iriyāpatha meditation, when the mind is directed towards the Sampajāna Pabbaya, when the mind is directed towards Dhātu Manasikāra meditation, when the mind is directed towards Vedanānupassanā, we should know how to apply effort at that time. Because when we focus

on those meditation themes, it's not going to work out by making effort in the same way. In various, diverse ways, effort should be applied there relevant to each contemplation (anupassanā). How is effort applied in that way? Let's try to explain, let's try to describe, how should effort be applied?

The mind begins to wander with lustful objects

Now consider, when we are directing our mind to the meditation theme, our mind turns towards a lustful object. Now the mind begins to wander with that object. After a while, one becomes aware of it. One realizes it. Now what should be done? That mind which has turned away, has left the lustful object and having recognized that it has left the lustful object, should be brought back to the meditation theme. The mind should be directed back to the meditation theme. Not only the mind be directed to the meditation theme, but effort should also be applied there again.
That "***So satova assasati, satova passasati.***" *With that mindfulness, one breathes in. One breathes out.* But within that breathing in and breathing out, there is an effort to prevent the mind from inclining again towards that lustful object. One maintains the mind again and again on the meditation theme with a thought connected to renunciation (nekkhamma). One prevents the mind from running back through external lustful objects and applies it to the meditation theme. Now, applying effort in this way, the mind, with renunciation as the basis, goes towards unification (ekaggatā) on the object.

There is conflict with sounds as well

Now, in this way, when we are directing our mind to the meditation theme, we may hear sounds externally. Now there is a conflict with those external objects of sound. So now what has happened? The mind disengages from the meditation theme. So now what should be

done? The mind is brought back to the meditation theme, recognizing the conflict with the sound. Afterwards, we apply effort to maintain the mind within the meditation theme based on non-conflict. Now sounds are heard from the external environment, now the mind neither turns towards them nor conflicts with them. The mind is maintained again and again within the meditation theme. Now there, having removed ill-will (vyāpāda), with non-ill-will (avyāpāda), the mind goes to unification within the meditation theme. Look, now the way effort is applied there is different. The way applied first is different there.

Going to unification means repeatedly directing the mind to the object, establishing mindfulness. Being able to recollect the object again and again by repeatedly directing the mind to it, 'without clinging' to external lustful objects. Being able to recollect the object again and again by repeatedly directing the mind to it, 'without conflict' with external sensual objects. Look, we are not applying effort in various ways like this. We have become accustomed to applying effort in the same way. One tries to unify the mind by firmly grasping the meditation object. Or one tries to see the meditation object, to establish mindfulness. There is a defect in the way we apply effort. One has not understood how to apply effort there, accordingly. That is why we are unable to settle within the arisen wholesome state. Unable to remain within that wholesome state. Applying effort in the same way, we do not get the expected results. The diversity in applying effort should be well understood.

The mind gradually withdraws

Now consider, there is sloth and torpor (thīnamiddha) in our mind. We abandon the meditation theme and fall asleep. So now what is to be done? Should we stop meditating? No. Now, having marked sloth and torpor as sloth and torpor, one directs the mind back to the

meditation theme, establishing mindfulness. Establishing mindfulness in that way, we should strive to recognize the meditation theme again and again. Because sloth and torpor arose due to the inability to recognize the meditation theme. As the meditation theme becomes more and more wornout, more and more subtle, the object does not appear to the mind. So the mind gradually withdraws. Sloth and torpor means the recession, the contraction, of mind and mental factors (cittacetasika dhamma). Now there exists a nature where the mind does not turn again and again towards the object. Look now, when the object becomes subtle, it is not perceived clearly.

Then the mind should go to unification through the light sign (āloka saññā). If so, then there, turning back to the object, recognizing that the object has become subtle and faded away, one establishes mindfulness and remains. Until the subtle object is recognized again. Until it is perceived clearly. There, one applies effort to recognize the subtle object again. Applying effort in this way, establishing mindfulness, behold, the subtle object, the faded object, becomes clear to our mind again and again. Now the mind does not recede. The mental factors do not contract. They turn towards that very subtle object. Look now, then the effort applied there was for the purpose of making the object clear.

Now then, if you, without succumbing to sloth and torpor, first recognize when sloth and torpor arise and get accustomed to applying effort in that way. Look, the way we applied effort here is different from the two ways we talked about earlier. Here the mind went to unification through the light sign.

Our mind begins to scatter

Alright, next, when we are maintaining the mind within the meditation theme, our mind begins to scatter. Now the mind disengages from the meditation theme. Having first recognized that fact as before, one again directs the mind to the meditation theme,

establishing mindfulness, not allowing the mind to wander with various objects. There, with non-agitation (avikkhepa) as the basis, the mind goes to unification. The way effort is applied there is different from all three previous ways. These need to be explained in more detail than this. However, today we hope to describe the Ānāpānasati meditation theme in depth and at length. Saving time for that, I will describe another way of applying effort.

There is no other way to dispel doubt

While we are directing our mind to the meditation theme and establishing mindfulness, behold, then, doubts and uncertainties arise regarding the meditation practice. Various doubts and uncertainties arise in the mind. Is this like this? Is this correct? Or if I do this, is it correct? etc. Now what has arisen in the mind is doubt and uncertainty, which should first be well understood and recognized as doubt and uncertainty. Having recognized and understood it, one directs the mind to the meditation theme, again and again establishing mindfulness, and now one should determine the Dhamma. Now one determines the Dhamma relevant to those doubts and uncertainties. One investigates there.
Is it like this? Or not? Is it like this? Or not? etc., as doubts arose. As we said in the morning sermon, behold, "Should I mentally note, direct the mind? Or not?" we get a doubt. Then, to dispel that doubt there, we practice by mentally noting, directing the mind to the object again and again. And also, we practice by without mentally noting, not directing the mind to the object. Now does the doubt get dispelled? Or not? It gets dispelled. But without determining the Dhamma in both ways like that, there is no other way to dispel that doubt. Without doing it in that way, one cannot dispel that doubt by just thinking and pondering. Look, there the mind went to unification based on the determination of Dhamma. The way effort was applied here is different from all four previous situations.

Effort should be applied again and again

There, there, having recognized the problems in meditation, one should solve our questions relevant to those problems, directing the mind to the meditation theme, applying effort again and again. Regarding these points, we are describing the application of effort today. Otherwise, meditators ask and talk mostly about information regarding establishing mindfulness. One should also be concerned about, pay attention to, the application of effort. Without applying effort in that way, developing mindfulness does not happen.

Without applying effort, results are not obtained

We plant a tree. Just watering that tree is not enough. After planting the tree, we put a few fences around it for the tree's protection. Not only that, during the daytime, strong sun. We surround it with some leaves and branches. But even that is not enough, we need to add various things like fertilizer again and again. Without providing such nourishment and care to the plant, we do not get the expected benefit or result from the plant. And so it is, meritorious devotees. Without applying effort there, there, understanding the matters regarding the meditation object, we do not get the expected results.

As soon as doubt comes, one cannot progress in meditation

Look, when sloth and torpor comes, one succumbs to it and abandons meditation. "The mind scatters, I can't meditate," and one gives up meditation. As soon as some painful feeling arises in the body, conflicted with that pain, one stops meditating. While meditating, thoughts arise to eat, to cook, to read books, to watch TV. Succumbing to the desire for those lustful objects, one abandons meditation. Look, at those places, if those are not recognized and

effort is not applied, the five hindrances (nīvaraṇa dhammā) arise one after another and one abandons meditation. If doubt comes, one cannot progress further in meditation. Dullness, regret, anger, sloth and torpor, etc., hindrances arise. Doubt should be recognized and the mind directed back to meditation. That is what it means to apply effort. According to there, there, the way effort should be applied, what should we do having understood? Effort should be applied.

The problem is not properly understood

If we had learned these from a young age in life, we would not be where we are now as a country, as a nation. Look, how did we apply effort when problems arose in life? If we already watered the plant in the morning, we only have to water it again in the evening. But from morning until evening, many other tasks related to it should be done there, there. We look for solutions in the same way. And we look for easy methods. But in the end, when the result is obtained, we are not satisfied. Not only that, almost everything we do is half-done. Either half-done, or stopped right where we started. So according to that, what should be understood is that effort was not applied properly, the problem was not properly understood.

So how do we live happily?

Really, if we had learned about these cittacetasika dhammā (dhamma of mind and mental factors) from childhood, we could have made life successful in every way by now. We could have won in life in every way by now. Instead of sorrow, regret, grief, pain, tears, the mind would be filled with happiness, peace. Look, we do not know about chanda (interest), vīriya (effort), sati (mindfulness), paññā (wisdom), saddhā (faith), karuṇā (compassion), mettā (loving-kindness), muditā (sympathetic joy), upekkhā (equanimity). We do not recognize these. So how do we win? So how do we live happily? So how do we finish our work?

Investigate only what is relevant

When watering, we should investigate only what is relevant to watering. When applying fertilizer, we should investigate only what is relevant to applying fertilizer. If we investigate in that way, there, there, regarding each matter, we have investigated regarding the whole. There is no confusion. What we often do is confuse everything. When a problem comes, we do not investigate relevant to the problem. So we do not get the answer we expect from solving that problem. We do not listen to the Dhamma enough. We do not arrange it in order.

The Blessed Lord Buddha has attained Parinibbāna

So we should also apply effort regarding meditation, after properly realized of it. So questions regarding meditation should be asked, There, there, according to how the mind behaves, to know how to act. Then we will explain it as we know. And also, a question should be asked from someone who has solved questions. So from whom, if asked, do we get the purest, most correct answer to our questions? From whom is it suitable to expect answers to questions in the first place? Meritorious devotees, it is from the Lord Buddha. But now the Lord Buddha has attained Parinibbāna (final emancipation). That opportunity we will not receive again within this Buddha Sasana.

The Great Arahants have attained Parinibbāna

Next, meritorious devotees, we would have to take our questions to Venerable great Arahant Sāriputta Mahāthera, to Venerable great Arahant Moggallāna Mahāthera, to Venerable great Arahant Mahākassapa Mahāthera, in that way, in order, to the eighty great disciple great Arahants. But now the chief disciples Venerable great Arahant Sāriputta and Moggallāna Mahātheros and the great

disciple great Arahants have attained Parinibbāna. That opportunity we will not receive again within this Buddha Sasana.

Those who have attained the Path and Fruit still dwell today

But it has recorded in the Dhamma (in the tipitaka) the way those sublime great sages practiced. And also, even today, there are great meditators, both local and foreign, who have dedicated their entire lives to meditation and have attained the Path and Fruit (maggaphala), who are dwelling.

Practice this Dhamma properly without delay

On one occasion, the Blessed Lord Buddha preached thus to Venerable Ānanda: "*Ānanda, for what reason do the community of monks now expect from me? Ānanda, I have taught the Dhamma without making a distinction between inner and outer groups. Ānanda, in the Dhamma of the Tathāgatas (realized one), there is no 'closed fist of the teacher'.*"

So, you too meritorious devotees, having properly understood that meaning, practice this Dhamma properly without delay.
So, we will end here the part that we expected to preach today related to making effort.

Let's talk about the Ānāpānasati meditation theme

Alright, now today, let's talk about the Ānāpānasati meditation theme, which we placed as our main sermon topic. We have already taught you how to practice Ānāpānasati meditation. It is as a condensed sermon, compiling that whole collection of sermons, that we are giving this sermon. Because we have already explained the Ānāpānasati meditation theme relevant to Kāyānupassanā (contemplation of the body) part by part in several programs. Today, while briefly describing those points, we hope to present this sermon up to the point of realizing the Four Noble Truths, up to the point of attaining the Noble Eightfold Path.

How mindfulness and wisdom grew there in each place

Take the book Ekāyana Mārgaya (a book on four foundations of mindfulness) given to you, meritorious devotees, turn to page 41. At the end of page 41, it is mentioned: **Atthi kāyoti vā**. Let's read that part, meritorious devotees.

Atthi kāyoti vā panassa sati paccupaṭṭhitā hoti. Yāvadeva ñāṇamattāya patissatimattāya anissito ca viharati. Na ca kiñci loke upādiyati.

Now let's look at the English meaning.
Mindfulness is established thus: 'There is a body,' for the sake of increase of wisdom in future, increase of mindfulness in future and for dwelling independent of craving and views. And for not clinging to anything in the world of the aggregates of clinging.

Look, meritorious devotees, **Atthi kāyoti vā panassa sati paccupaṭṭhitā hoti.** It is preached to establish mindfulness by taking up "there is a body." **Yāvadeva ñāṇamattāya**, for the increase of wisdom in future, **patissatimattāya**, for the increase of mindfulness

in future, **anissito ca viharati**, for dwelling independent of craving and views, **na ca kiñci loke upādiyati**, for not clinging to anything in the world of the aggregates of clinging.

So, as we practice the Ānāpānasati meditation theme step by step up to the very end, after finished related to each individual path and looking back at the path traversed, we should see, up to the point of realizing the Four Noble Truths, how mindfulness and wisdom grew there in each point along the path, with road marks.
So what we hope to mention in today's sermon is how to proceed step by step up to that very end. This is a very difficult task. To the best of our ability, we hope to proceed step by step with this profound sermon.

How many signs and indications are in your mind?

Take the book again, meritorious devotees, turn to page 39.

Idha bhikkhave, bhikkhu araññagato vā rukkhamūlagato vā suññāgāragato vā nisīdati pallaṅkaṃ ābhujitvā ujuṃ kāyaṃ paṇidhāya parimukhaṃ satiṃ upaṭṭhapetvā.

Alright, let's proceed by understanding up to there.
Now we have instructed you, "Do not direct the mind to the breath at once, directing it to the parimukha." "Take up the signs of the surrounding environment." Today, regarding this meditation center.
Let's see according to the order of the sermon. **Araññagato vā, rukkhamūlagato vā, suññāgāragato vā**. Meritorious devotees, **araññagato vā**, if gone to the forest, one takes up the signs of that forest well in mind, regarding temples and such. **rukkhamūlagato vā**, if at the root of a tree, regarding the surrounding environment of that tree root. **suññāgāragato vā**, regarding the empty hut. This means "take up the visible signs present in the environment you are in."

Why, meritorious devotees, did we tell you that you should do that? Look now, how many signs and indications are in your mind regarding the world, regarding things seen, heard, and done in the world. All those signs are abandoned as soon as one takes up this one forest sign, tree-root sign, or empty-hut sign. Now since you are in the forest monastery, your mind contains signs and indications relevant to that taken forest sign.

Taking up signs and indications relevant to the forest sign (araññа saññā) is the first step, the journey up to the Noble Eightfold Path with the Ānāpānasati meditation theme. Meritorious devotees, we have already described this in previous sermons.

Practice sense restraint

Now we have moved one step forward. That is freeing the mind from those gross signs and indications gathered by directing the senses towards the external world. Now your mind contains signs and indications relevant to the forest sign.
Why do many people feel great happiness, lightness, and peace when they go to temples, shrine premises, Bodhi premises? It is because the mind is freed from those gross signs and rests on a pleasant sign. Many people practicing sense restraint say, "Now there is a greater lightness and peace in the mind compared to before. Restlessness, anger, are much less." What happens within sense restraint is the prevention of taking up external signs and indications of forms, etc. Look, that is why we explained these in the first place. Now you are experiencing those results.

Now, meritorious devotees, the place of dwelling is clear, isn't it? It is within the first step. That means we are now within the forest sign. The object appearing to our mind is the forest sign.

Alright, as the next step, the sermon mentions:

nisīdati pallaṅkaṃ ābhujitvā,
having folded the legs crosswise, and sits.

Direct your mind to the part of the body below the navel. Meritorious devotees, now you should well perceive how you are sitting with the legs folded. Now, meritorious devotees, you should perceive how the mind, turned from that forest sign towards the lower body part, below the navel, which is folded legs. Now another step forward has been taken. The mind has been directed from the forest sign to the sitting posture of the body, below the navel.

Directing the mind from the forest sign to the sitting posture of the body, below the navel is the second step in the journey towards the Noble Eightfold Path with the Ānāpānasati meditation theme.

Begin to search for oneself

Now, meritorious devotees, let's look at the third step, the next step:

Ujuṃ kāyaṃ paṇidhāya,
Having straightened the body.

Now you are dwelling with the mind directed to the lower part below the navel, perceiving the manner of sitting with legs folded.

Now direct your mind, meritorious devotees, to the upper part of the body. Now then it will be perceived by your mind, how the upper part of the body is straightened. And so, meritorious devotees, we feel, we see with our mind, how our body is placed. Now look, what appears to our mind is the manner in which we are sitting. We see with our own mind how our own body is placed.

Meritorious devotees, how many times a day do we perceive like this? Does it appear like this?

Meritorious devotees, we do not direct our mind towards ourselves at all, the vast majority. So, they do not perceive like this. From the time we wake up until we go to sleep at night, our mind is directed towards, looked towards the external world. When will we ever see the truth in that way?
Now, meritorious devotees, begin to search for oneself. Is searching for ourselves good? Or is searching for others good? For so long, about whom have we been thinking, pondering, talking about? About others. About the external world. Do you see how, again and again, we came to the world? the mind goes down to the world? But we don't know that it is so. For you listening to this sermon, much more can be said about this, let's understand a little more here, and let's move forward, meritorious devotees, otherwise we will take too much time.

Arriving at this third step, what appears to us is the manner in which the body is placed. And also look at how the mind was directed towards the body. The mind, which was directed towards the world, turned towards the forest. From there, it turned towards the place of sitting with legs folded. After that, the entire manner in which the body is placed was perceived. The order of abandonment is there from the beginning. Look at how the path traveled is also there in order.

And also, it is not just the things thought, pondered, talked about, remembered while subject to the external world, but also the attachments, conflicts, measurements, etc., defilements that were in our mind are now abandoned. Look, at the very place of beginning meditation, at the very moment of beginning meditation, a great lightness, peace, comfort is felt because of that. Moment by

moment, while directing the mind to meditation, we can see this abandonment.

And also, step by step, that abandonment becomes stronger and stronger. The mind finds relief from those defilements. That annoyance, that pressure of defilements, right there, in this present moment, when the mind is inclined towards the body and sees the body, completely disappears, becomes subdued. One who has seen, understood, has mindfulness and wisdom regarding this matter, does not incline the mind again towards that external world. Again and again, one directs the mind towards this very body. We have not seen and read about it in this way. meritorious devotees, one who has seen it, one who has read about it, does not abandon Iriyāpatha Pabbaya (postures section), Sampajāna Pabbaya (clear comprehension section) throughout the day. Searching for oneself, to put it bluntly, does not stop. One begins to search for oneself continuously.

Look, you, directing the mind to **parimukha** (front of the face) and establishing mindfulness, then want to quickly go on a journey directing the mind to the breath. One cannot go like that, meritorious devotees. What is in the mind there? Haste, restlessness. That should be recognized and removed. That is why we said at the beginning, "not establishing mindfulness by directing the mind to the parimukha at once, let's go step by step like this." Now understand, **araññagato vā rukkhamūlagato vā suññāgāragato vā** exists for many reasons. That is one reason. So one should proceed forward mindful of the order.

Now, meritorious devotees, sitting with legs folded, having straightened the body. Now, good mindfulness and wisdom arise as to why one is sitting with legs folded, having straightened the body on the ground. For what is one sitting? To meditate. Not for anything else. Now then, that message goes correctly to one's mind only if one sees the manner of sitting with legs folded and having

straightened the body like this. Then, relevant to that, the mind begins to function. Faith, effort, mindfulness, interest for meditation arise well in the mind. So behold, from the first forest sign, directing the mind to the sitting posture with legs folded is the second step in the journey towards the Noble Eightfold Path with the Ānāpānasati meditation theme. That step was described mentioning many points. The third step is ***ujuṃ kāyaṃ paṇidhāya***, *straightening the body.*

Another step forward has been taken

Now, meritorious devotees, next the lord Buddha preaches:

Parimukhaṃ satiṃ upaṭṭhapetvā.
Establish mindfulness at the ***parimukha***.

Do not mistake this step, meritorious devotees. If so, meditation will not develop up to the Noble Eightfold Path. If we mistake this step means, you can understand that from here onwards the whole meditation theme goes wrong. To develop the meditation theme from here onwards, this step should be marked correctly. So how do we correctly pass this step?
Meritorious devotees, in the **Vibhaṅga Prakaraṇa's Jhāna Vibhaṅga** and in the **Paṭisambhidāmagga Prakaraṇa's Ānāpānasati Kathā**, this is clearly described.

How is that?

Ayaṃ sati upaṭṭhitā hoti supaṭṭhitā nāsikagge vā mukhanimitte vā. Tena vuccati 'parimukhaṃ satiṃ upaṭṭhapetvā'ti.

When this mindfulness is established, either at ***nāsikagga*** *or at mukhanimitta, it is well established. Therefore it is said,* ***'parimukhaṃ satiṃ upaṭṭhapetvā'***.

Look, meritorious devotees, to pass this step correctly, one should be aware of it in that way. Otherwise, one goes wrong. Many mistake this **nāsikagga**. They assume. “Nāsikagga means the top above the upper lip where the nostril begins”, many of them say. That is wrong. That is not the end, it is the beginning of the nose. Nāsikagga is inevitably encountered when abandoned mukhanimitta and practicing the meditation theme deeply.

Next, another mistake is made, that is, saying "look at the place where the breath touches." "That is **the mukhanimitta or the nāsikagga**," they say. That is not so. Because the sermon has not yet spoken about the breath. It preaches to mark the **parimukha** and then only turn towards the breath. Otherwise, the meditator cannot settle in the meditation theme, when the breath cannot sense. After the step of **sabbakāya paṭisaṃvedī**, a breath wave does not sense at all. The breath wave ends there. I will describe that again in that step. So, saying to look at the place where the breath touches is also wrong.

Meritorious devotees, there are two lines between the nostrils and the upper lip, have you seen them when looking in a mirror? That sign, perception, mark, you should recollect well in mind, remember, reflect upon. Again and again recollect, remember, reflect and look. Alright, now your mind should be directed to the **parimukha**. That is **mukhanimitta**. Now, having marked the mukhanimitta in that way, one should proceed to the next step. That is how it is in the sermon. We are now repeating these again and again. We have already explained them endlessly in previous sermons. Alright, in that way, that step is also marked.

Look, now, arriving at this fourth step, the manner of sitting with legs folded and the sitting posture is abandoned. Now, in that way,

another step forward has been taken, in the journey towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

It is by keep resting within the wholesomeness, that the clarity ahead becomes apparent

Now, meritorious devotees, after establishing mindfulness at the front, the next fifth step mentioned in the sermon is:

So satova assasati, satova passasati.

With that mindfulness, one breathes in.
With that mindfulness, one breathes out.

meritorious devotees, 'that mindfulness' mentioned refers to the mindfulness established on parimukha, i.e., **sati nimitta** (the mindfulness sign). Breathing in is the inhaling. Breathing out is the exhaling.

So, meritorious devotees, directing the mind again and again to the breath arriving at the sati nimitta, one mindfully breathes in, mindfully breathes out. Now the in-breath going up, the out-breath going down are perceived.

In this way, if you can continuously and mindfully take fifteen breath waves in and out without the mind turning anywhere else, look, a great skill, an ability has developed within you, hasn't it? And also, look at the restraint, the taming of the mind. In this manner you are taking in fifteen breath waves and letting out fifteen breath waves. In between, the mind does not scatter. Without remembering things done, said in the past, things to be done in the future, without the mind running through anger and displeasures, one breathes in. One breathes out.

Look, to what extent have you tamed this mind? Look, to what extent have you restrained this mind? During that time, you will begin to perceive a great experience, an understanding regarding wholesomeness, as well as the mind being free from the burden of defilements for the duration of fifteen breath waves.

When sitting, it is not good to sit thinking, "I am meditating in this way." We create a big plan and begin to meditate according to it. At that time, we only need to do what is to be done there in each place.

One needs to establish mindfulness by taking up 'there is a body.' That is what should be done after directing the mind to **parimukha**. When mindfulness is established and wisdom grows, everything we try to do, gets done. Everything we try to see, gets seen. There is nothing for us to search for with difficulty. This is something that happens without personal intervention. A law of cause and effect. The **opanaika** (forward-leading) nature of the Dhamma, leading to the next and next Dhamma nature. The Dhamma itself leads forward and forward. From the first step to the second step, etc. It does not happen through personal intervention. That should be understood. Struggling to go forward only makes one go further back.

You should strive to settle within the wholesomeness by directing the mind according to the Dhamma as mentioned, recognizing the wholesomeness in order. It is by keep settling within the wholesomeness, by keep resting within the wholesomeness, that the clarity ahead becomes apparent. One can go forward.

You breathe in mindfully, breathe out mindfully. Meritorious devotees, the in-breath arriving at the sati nimitta should be perceived. The out-breath arriving at the sati nimitta should be perceived. That means, not a part of the in-breath. Not a part of the out-breath. If it is a part of the in-breath, if it is a part of the

out-breath, you perceive then you cannot say you breathe in mindfully. You cannot say you breathe out mindfully. Because it is still half, only a part is completed.

Look at it this way. How much of the in-breath is perceived? How much of the out-breath is perceived? Then, how much of the in-breath is perceived, can be seen. How much of the out-breath is perceived, can be seen. And also, how much of the in-breath is not perceived, can be seen. How much of the out-breath is not perceived, can be seen. Recognize that the perceived amount is perceived because mindfulness is present. Recognize that the unperceived amount is not perceived because mindfulness is absent. Now, when the unperceived part of the in-breath arrives, when the unperceived part of the out-breath arrives, mindfulness certainly arises.

Now you can breathe in completely with mindfulness. You can breathe out completely with mindfulness. You will see that.
You will perceive that the in-breath begins from the sati nimitta. You will perceive that the in-breath ends at the sati nimitta. Between the beginning and the end, the in-breath will be completely perceived.
You will perceive that the out-breath begins from the **sati nimitta**. You will perceive that the out-breath ends at the **sati nimitta**. Between the beginning and the end, the out-breath will be completely perceived.
Now behold, you have the ability to say, one breathes with that mindfulness. Breathes out with that mindfulness.

So, you, without much restlessness, in this way, knowing the Dhamma relevant to that step, become skilled at recognizing that wholesomeness within yourself. Create this wholesomeness within yourself. Behold, now that fifth step is also ended, in the journey towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

The Dhamma has been well taught

Alright, meritorious devotees, let's go to the next step. The sermon mentions:

Dīghaṃ vā assasanto dīghaṃ assasāmīti pajānāti.
Dīghaṃ vā passasanto dīghaṃ passasāmīti pajānāti.

Breathing in long, he sees: 'I breathe in long';
Breathing out long, he sees: 'I breathe out long.'

Now look, arriving at this step, we encounter the word **pajānāti**. The meaning of that word is 'sees'. **Jānāti** means 'knows', **pajānāti** means 'sees with wisdom'. So look, arriving here, wisdom has now increased. It was preached to establish mindfulness by taking up 'there is a body' for the increase of wisdom to come. 'To come' mentioned there does not refer to something very far away. Something very near. Now this wisdom that arose will from here onwards grow very rapidly all the way to the Noble Eightfold Path.

Meritorious devotees, the Dhamma has been well taught. Look, before coming here, there was no nature of 'seeing the breath wave'. There was only 'the breath wave was perceived'. The reason is that there was only mindfulness there. There was no wisdom along with that mindfulness. Where there is only mindfulness, there is only 'the object is perceived'. But if there is wisdom along with mindfulness, 'the object is seen'. The more one can recollect the object well, the more wisdom arises. Let's see how wisdom arose here.
We told you, "To say one breathes in, out mindfully, half of the object being perceived is not enough," the in-breath is the upward movement of breath beginning from the sati nimitta and ending at the sati nimitta. The out-breath is the downward movement of breath beginning from the sati nimitta and ending at the sati nimitta.

Such recognition of ānāpāna is 'ānāpāna saññā' (the perception of in-and-out breathing).
Then, the complete upward movement of breath, by recollection, is marked as this much is 'inhale'. That marking, that seeing, is the wisdom there. That is where wisdom arose based on inhaling.
Then, the complete downward movement of breath, by recollection, is marked as this much is 'exhale'. That marking, that seeing, is the wisdom there. That is where wisdom arose based on exhaling.
Now, in that way, the breath wave traveling upward, traveling downward happens, is starting to seen. The time taken for that travel is also perceived. Based on that ānāpāna saññā or based on the time taken, one sees: 'I breathe in long' and 'I breathe out long.'
If the ānāpāna saññā is long, one sees it as long. If the time taken for ānāpāna is long, one sees it as long. For meditators, sometimes based on the ānāpāna saññā, sometimes based on the time taken, this seeing happens in both ways.

Alright, we have now described as the sixth step: *Breathing in long, he sees: 'I breathe in long'; breathing out long, he sees: 'I breathe out long,'* in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

<u>How clear the path to Nibbāna is, meritorious devotees</u>

Rassaṃ assasanto vā 'rassaṃ assasāmī'ti pajānāti,
rassaṃ passasanto vā 'rassaṃ passasāmī'ti pajānāti.

Breathing in short, he sees: 'I breathe in short';
Breathing out short, he sees: 'I breathe out short.'

Now look, meritorious devotees, at this point, how much more rapidly mindfulness and wisdom grow. The mindfulness and wisdom existing in the previous step are surpassed by the mindfulness and wisdom existing here now. Step by step, the qualities of the Dhamma itself

emerge to the mind. What a wonder is this Dhamma preached by the Blessed Buddha to this world! How clear the path to Nibbāna is, meritorious devotees.

Now, proceeding according to the shortening of the breath wave, seeing, recollection happens. The breath gradually becomes shorter step by step. That shortening breath is marked as short. And also, the time taken for the breath wave becomes very short. Therefore, compared to the mindfulness that existed before, there is greater mindfulness within this step for seeing, recollection, which you can recognize. And also, if this mindfulness and wisdom will not grow, this breath wave will be abandoned. That too you can recognize.
In this way, you are dwelling there seeing short in-breath as short in-breath and seeing short out-breath as short out-breath. When your mindfulness and wisdom grow very deeply within this step, the in-and-out breath becomes so short that they become indistinguishable.
Despite such a short breath wave, the meditator can proceed without difficulty in the meditation theme, maintaining mindfulness and wisdom. Such skill has been obtained by the development of mindfulness and wisdom by now. And also, repeatedly, rapidly directing the mind to the object and maintaining it means the nature of a well-utilized mind. Here, if needed, much more detail can be given, for now this is it.

Alright, we have now described as the seventh step: *Breathing in short, he sees: 'I breathe in short'; or breathing out short, he sees: 'I breathe out short,'* in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

<u>The path to Nibbāna is very near</u>

Now behold, according to the mindfulness and wisdom growing here, the sermon mentions an extremely important step. Within this step,

the path to Nibbāna comes very close. If we do not correctly identify and work according to this step as mentioned in the sermon, meditation stops here. We encounter many people are not knowing how to proceed from here. But the path to Nibbāna is very near. Let's examine the meaning mentioned in the sermon, meritorious devotees.

Sabbakāya paṭisaṃvedī assasissāmīti sikkhati.
Sabbakāya paṭisaṃvedī passasissāmīti sikkhati.

'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself.
'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains himself.

Behold in this step, here the breath wave is mentioned in the future tense. That is, look, earlier in the long and short breath, **assasāmīti** was mentioned. There it was mentioned in the present tense.
Look here, that word is in the future tense. **Assasissāmīti** is how it is preached.
And also, in the previous two steps, **pajānāti** was how it was preached. From here onwards, **sikkhati** is how it is preached.
Let us hold that knowledge, hold those things behind, and proceed a little further.

The word **sabbakāya** mentioned in the sermon means 'the whole body'. Meritorious devotees, what is meant by 'the whole body'? Let's try to say? Regarding this, **the Ānāpānasati Kathā in the Paṭisambhidāmagga Prakaraṇa** describes what this 'whole body' is, like this.

kāyoti dve kāyā: nāmakāyo ca rūpakāyo ca.

katamo nāmakāyo? vedanā, saññā, cetanā, phasso, manasikāro, nāmañca nāmakāyo ca, ye ca vuccanti cittasaṅkhārā, ayaṃ nāmakāyo.

katamo rūpakāyo? cattāro ca mahābhūtā, catunnañca mahābhūtānaṃ upādāyarūpaṃ, assāso ca passāso ca, nimittañca upanibandhanā, ye ca vuccanti kāyasaṅkhārā, ayaṃ rūpakāyo.

Body: *There are two bodies: the mental body and the material body.*

What is the ***mental body****? Feeling, perception, volition, contact, attention, and the name and the group of mental phenomena, whatever phenomena are called mental formations, this is the* ***mental body.***

What is the ***material body****? The four great elements, and material form derived from the four great elements, in-breath, out-breath, the sign, the place of contact (where in-and-out breath touches), whatever phenomena are called bodily formations, this is the* ***material body.***

Now look, meritorious devotees, **sabbakāya** is mentioned in the sermon like that. Many people do not know how to practice the Ānāpānasati meditation theme from there as the breath wave becomes shorter and more subtle. They do not understand how to practice mindfulness. We already described the short breath well in the seventh step.

Now, meritorious devotees, as the breath wave becomes more and more subtle in that way, while directing the mind to the breath and establishing mindfulness, we can recognize through the breath wave the characteristics of elements (dhātu), warmth, coolness, that is the fire element (**tejo dhātu**), and also a hitting nature, that is the earth element (**paṭhavī dhātu**), and also a vibrating, moving,

trembling nature, that is the wind element (**vāyo dhātu**). So in that way, when the elemental characteristics become manifest relevant to the material body, the perception of breath, the breath wave taken earlier, is abandoned. Now from here onwards, one must know how to see as elements.

When elemental characteristics become manifest, if those elemental characteristics are not recognized, one goes astray. Many people are astray here. When elemental characteristics become manifest, one must recognize them and direct the mind as elements. Now from here onwards, the breath wave is abandoned. From here onwards, one must proceed seeing as mentality-materiality (nāmarūpa). That is why the breath wave is mentioned in the future tense, as **assasissāmīti**. We said earlier we would talk about that later. Behold, now we have spoken about it here.

When elemental characteristics become manifest, they must be recognized and the mind directed. Having recognized as elements, directing the mind to those elemental characteristics, establishing mindfulness again and again, now one has to train. **Sikkhati** is preached. To train means in all three meanings of higher virtue (**adhisīla**), higher mind (**adhicitta**), higher wisdom (**adhipaññā**).

sabbakāyapaṭisaṃvedī assāsapassāsānaṃ saṃvaraṭṭhena sīlavisuddhi, avikkhepaṭṭhena cittavisuddhi, dassanaṭṭhena diṭṭhivisuddhi.
yo tattha saṃvaraṭṭho, ayaṃ adhisīlasikkhā. yo tattha avikkhepaṭṭho, ayaṃ adhicittasikkhā. yo tattha dassanaṭṭho, ayaṃ adhipaññāsikkhā.
imā tisso sikkhāyo āvajjanto sikkhati, jānanto sikkhati, passanto sikkhati, paccavekkhanto sikkhati, cittaṃ adhiṭṭhahanto sikkhati, saddhāya adhimuccanto sikkhati, vīriyaṃ paggaṇhanto sikkhati, satiṃ upaṭṭhapento sikkhati, cittaṃ samādahanto sikkhati, paññāya pajānanto sikkhati, abhiññeyyaṃ abhijānanto sikkhati,

pariññeyyaṃ parijānanto sikkhati, pahātabbaṃ pajahanto sikkhati, bhāvetabbaṃ bhāvento sikkhati, sacchikātabbaṃ sacchikaronto sikkhati.

The restraintful nature of all in-and-out breaths that make the whole in-and-out breath body manifest is virtue purification. The non-agitated nature is mind purification. The seeing nature is view purification.
Whatever restraintful nature there is, this is the training in higher virtue. Whatever non-agitated nature there is, this is the training in higher mind. Whatever seeing nature there is, this is the training in higher wisdom.
Training by remembering these three trainings, training with knowing, training with seeing, training with reflecting, training with determination, training being resolved in faith, training by making effort strong, training by arousing mindfulness, training by establishing the mind (on the object), training by comprehending with wisdom, training by knowing what is to be known by particular characteristics with particular characteristics, training by knowing what is to be known by general characteristics with general characteristics, training by abandoning what is to be abandoned, training by developing what is to be developed, training by realizing what is to be realized.

So, all forthcoming Ānāpānasati steps are described with **sikkhati**. Look at the Ānāpānasati Sutta discourse. Then one must work in that way from here onwards. Alright, now **pajānāti** is preached where it is mentioned, and from here onwards **sikkhati** is preached where it changes, we have described.

One more place needs to be described. That is regarding the **mental body**. When elemental characteristics become manifest, recognize them and direct the mind. Directing the mind to those elemental characteristics, establishing mindfulness again and again, now one

trains. Then you can recognize elemental characteristics separately. The mark, sign of elemental characteristics separately, as the perception. The mind directed to elemental characteristics. There, feelings, attention, volition, etc., mental phenomena also begin to become manifest. So, to recognize these in this way, one must have knowledge regarding the intrinsic characteristics of mentality-materiality phenomena. That is why we have provided you with the printed book called Pañcaskandhaya (a book on five aggrigates). Behold, in that way, when the mental body also becomes manifest, now,

Sabbakāya paṭisaṃvedī assasissāmīti sikkhati.
Sabbakāya paṭisaṃvedī passasissāmīti sikkhati.

'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself.
'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains himself,
as mentioned in the sermon, having properly understood that step, one must train. Then one arrives and dwells within that step.

Alright, we have now described as the eighth step: *'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself. 'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains himself,* in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

<u>This is the final step</u>

Now, meritorious devotees, we hope to describe the next step mentioned in the sermon. This is the final step, encountered on the way to attaining the Noble Eightfold Path from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme. Meritorious devotees, that step is mentioned in the sermon like this.

Passambhayaṃ kāyasaṅkhāraṃ assasissāmīti sikkhati.
Passambhayaṃ kāyasaṅkhāraṃ passasissāmīti sikkhati.

'Calming the bodily formation, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself.
'Calming the bodily formation, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains himself.

We described in the previous step about the whole body; what is meant by bodily formation (kāyasaṅkhāra) was mentioned there. Bodily formation means:

Katamo rūpakāyo? Cattāro ca mahābhūtā catunnañca mahābhūtānaṃ upādāya rūpaṃ assāso ca passāso ca nimittañca upanibandhanā, ye ca vuccanti kāyasaṅkhārā, ayaṃ rūpakāyo.

What is the material body? The four great elements, and material form derived from the four great elements, in-breath, out-breath, the sign, the place of contact (where in-and-out breath touches), whatever phenomena are called bodily formations, this is the material body.

It is preached thus: *'Calming the bodily formation, I shall breathe in, breathe out,' thus he trains himself.* Let us further examine and understand this. Now what is bodily formation? We know.

'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself. 'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains himself, there the whole body means the mental body and the material body. When we see this mentality-materiality body, first the elemental characteristics became manifest. We trained seeing the elemental characteristics in the three ways described above.

Next, the group of mental phenomena also began to become manifest.

In this way, while training by experiencing the whole body, virtue, concentration, wisdom grow further, and there, while training with one of elemental characteristic along with mental phenomena becoming manifest, one gets to see either **the nature of arising** or **the nature of passing away** of those mentality-materiality phenomena.

If you saw the nature of arising, along with that vision, wisdom arises regarding the **udaya** (arising) of these mentality-materiality phenomena.

Next, you see a cessation, an ending, a breaking up of those arising mentality-materiality phenomena, along with that vision, wisdom arises regarding the **vaya** (passing away) of these mentality-materiality phenomena.

In this way, the wisdom that arises with the vision of the nature of arising or passing away of these mentality-materiality phenomena, we call **udayabbaya ñāṇa** or **udaya vaya ñāṇa** (arising and passing away knowledge).

Now, meritorious devotees, this arisen udaya vaya ñāṇa must be developed further. For that, what must be done is to dwell continuously directing the mind again and again to the characteristics of arising and passing away, seeing this mentality-materiality body.

As udaya vaya ñāṇa develops and develops, the meditator will see: udaya means beginning, vaya means ending. And also, there is an in-between to be seen. Look, regarding that, it is well mentioned in the sermon.

Saṅkhatānaṃ saccānaṃ uppādo paññāyati, vayo paññāyati, ṭhitānaṃ aññathattaṃ paññāyati.

Of conditioned truths, the arising is discerned, the passing away is discerned, the change of what is present is discerned.

Now, meritorious devotees, behold, that meditator also directs the mind to that nature existing between arising and passing away.

Meritorious devotees, at this point, the faculties (indriya) have developed and ended, the powers (bala) have developed and ended, where the powers have developed and ended, there it is seen that there is an in-between changing, as mentioned: ***ṭhitānaṃ aññathattaṃ paññāyati***. Now the mind is fully inclined towards Nibbāna, it is the enlightenment factors (bojjhaṅga dhammā) that develop here. Now, meritorious devotees,

Samudayadhammānupassī vā kāyasmiṃ viharati.
Vayadhammānupassī vā kāyasmiṃ viharati.

He dwells seeing the nature of origin (arising from cause) in the body,
or he dwells seeing the nature of passing away in the body,
is mentioned in the sermon.

Meritorious devotees, in this way, while dwelling again and again seeing **samudaya vaya** in the body, earlier when we showed **udaya vaya**, what appears there is only arising and passing away. That is, only beginning and end. Here, where **samudaya vaya** (origin and passing away) is mentioned, what appears is arising, passing away, and the complete in-between. That is the difference there. That different vision's nature, with that, the same word is not used. That vision is preached as **samudaya vaya**.

Meritorious devotees, while dwelling in this way again and again seeing samudaya vaya in the body, one gets to see how a body is formed from ignorance as cause, and the cessation of the body from the cessation of ignorance. Let's understand this place a little more carefully.

Meritorious devotees, let's go back a little to the beginning of the mentality-materiality phenomenon you are investigating. We explained to you there: "While training with one of elemental characteristic along with mental phenomena becoming manifest, one gets to see either the nature of arising or the nature of passing away of those mentality-materiality phenomena."

Now, meritorious devotees, let's assume that 'one of elemental characteristic' is the 'wind element'. Then, having trained seeing the arising and passing away of that wind element, it further changes, and the in-between is also seen, dwelling seeing in this way is where we are now, behold, at that point, the mind cannot rest further on the wind element in that way, because the adhesion contact (**adhivacana samphassa**) from mentality to materiality and the impingement contact (**patigha samphassa**) from materiality to mentality also cease. With that vision, at that point, mentality is seen separately and materiality is seen separately completely. Meritorious devotees, how is that? Let's understand a little more carefully, meritorious devotees.

That materiality, the aggregate of material that is clung to (**rūpupādānakkhandho**) is seen.

Mentality is also separated as aggregates that is clung to,

Within that group of mental phenomena, the existing feeling, as the aggregate of feeling that is clung to (**vedanupādānakkhandho**), is seen separately.

Within that group of mental phenomena, the existing perception, as the aggregate of perception that is clung to (**saññupādānakkhandho**), is seen separately.

Within that group of mental phenomena, the other group of mental concomitants, as the aggregate of formation that is clung to (**saṅkhārupādānakkhandho**), is seen separately.

And also, the consciousness based on mentality-materiality phenomena, is seen separately as the aggregate of consciousness that is clung to (**viññāṇupādānakkhandho**).

With mentality-materiality consciousness converting quickly, how saṃsāra was formed, and seeing the truth, how one crossed over from saṃsāra, well reflected, behold, meritorious devotees,
in this way, all five aggregates appear to you separately at once.

Now what is reflected upon is,

Idaṃ dukkhan'ti yoniso manasi karoti.
"This is suffering," he reflects wisely.

Ayaṃ dukkhasamudayo'ti yoniso manasi karoti.
And also, that craving which created this suffering again and again is seen separately as the origin of suffering. There, *"this is the origin of suffering" is reflected upon.*

Idaṃ dukkhanirodho'ti yoniso manasi karoti.
And also, within this vision, the aggregates, elements, sense bases that arose without an interval, cease for a moment. One realizes the

cessation of becoming, Nibbāna. There, *"this is the cessation of suffering" is reflected upon.*

Ayaṃ dukkhanirodhagāminīpaṭipadā'ti yoniso manasi karoti.
The Noble Eightfold Path arises. There, *"this is the path or practice leading to the cessation of suffering" is reflected upon.*

Along with this vision, the Four Noble Truths are well seen separately. What is seen, is reflected upon as it is seen.

And also, meritorious devotees, along with this vision, knowledge of suffering (**dukkhe ñāṇa**) arises.

And also, meritorious devotees, along with this vision,
knowledge of the origin of suffering (**dukkhasamudaye ñāṇa**) arises.

And also, meritorious devotees, along with this vision,
knowledge of the cessation of suffering (**dukkhanirodhe ñāṇa**) arises.

And also, meritorious devotees, along with this vision,
knowledge of the path leading to the cessation of suffering (**dukkhanirodhagāminiyā paṭipadāya ñāṇa**) arises.

Virajaṃ vītamalaṃ dhammacakkhuṃ udapādi. Yaṃ kiñci samudayadhammaṃ, sabbaṃ taṃ nirodhadhammanti.

The dust-free, stainless Dhamma eye (knowledge of path to first stage of enlightenment) arose: "Whatever is subject to arising is all subject to cessation," is preached, for this sublime arrival, for this sublime seeing, meritorious devotees.

Here, "one sees the quick conversion of **mentality-materiality consciousness**," we said, one sees how **mentality-materiality** exists

conditioned by **consciousness**, and how mentality-materiality ceases with the cessation of consciousness, and also, how **a body** is formed from **ignorance** as cause, and the cessation of the body from the cessation of ignorance, we said, then what is seen there is dependent origination (paṭicca samuppāda).
Dependent origination means,

Imasmiṃ sati idaṃ hoti
Imassuppādā idaṃ uppajjati
Imasmiṃ asati idaṃ na hoti
Imassa nirodhā idaṃ nirujjhati

When this is, that is exists.
From the arising of this, that arises.
When this is not, that is not exists.
From the cessation of this, that ceases.

When ignorance is, a body is; from the arising of ignorance, the body arises. When ignorance is not, the body is not; from the cessation of ignorance, the body ceases.

When consciousness is, mentality-materiality is; from the arising of consciousness, mentality-materiality arises. When consciousness is not, mentality-materiality is not; from the cessation of consciousness, mentality-materiality ceases.

Look, in this way, to see the Four Noble Truths, to see dependent origination, what must we do? Develop **the four foundations of mindfulness.**

It is to produce this very vision that it is preached to establish mindfulness by taking up 'there is a body' within **the four foundations of mindfulness.**

In the Mahāhatthipadopama Sutta discourse, the way much work is completed within this Buddha Sasana (dispensation of the lord buddha), regarding the seeing of the Four Noble Truths and dependent origination, is preached thus, meritorious devotees,

"Vuttaṃ kho panetaṃ bhagavatā: 'yo paṭiccasamuppādaṃ passati so dhammaṃ passati. Yo dhammaṃ passati so paṭiccasamuppādaṃ passatī'ti. Paṭiccasamuppannā kho panime yadidaṃ pañcupādānakkhandhā. Yo imesu pañcasupādānakkhandhesu chando ālayo anunayo ajjhosānaṃ so dukkhassamudayo, yo imesu pañcasupādānakkhandhesu chandarāgavinayo chandarāgappahānaṃ so dukkhanirodho'ti. Ettāvatāpi kho āvuso bhikkhuno bahukataṃ hotī"ti.

"This has been said by the Blessed One: 'One who sees dependent origination sees the Dhamma. One who sees the Dhamma sees dependent origination.' These five aggregates subject to clinging are dependently originated. Whatever desire, attachment, affection, insistence in these five aggregates subject to clinging, that is the origin of suffering. Whatever removal of desire and passion, abandoning of desire and passion in these five aggregates subject to clinging, that is the cessation of suffering. By this much too, friend, a monk has done much in the Buddha's teachings."

Alright, we have now described as the ninth step: *'Calming the bodily formation, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself. 'Calming the bodily formation, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains himself*, in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path. So, behold, that is how the calming of the bodily formation should be known. Now let us review these **nine steps** from beginning to end, meritorious devotees.

Alright, we have now described as the **first step**: directing the mind to the forest sign, in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

Alright, we have now described as the **second step**: directing the mind from the forest sign to the sitting posture below the navel, in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

Alright, we have now described as the **third step**: objectifying the entire body by objectifying the posture of sitting, in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

Alright, we have now described as the **fourth step**: directing the mind to the sati nimitta (i.e. parimukha), in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

Alright, we have now described as the **fifth step**: breathing in and out with the mindfulness established at the parimukha, in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

Alright, we have now described as the **sixth step**: seeing long in-breath, long out-breath, in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

Alright, we have now described as the **seventh step**: seeing short in-breath, short out-breath, in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

Alright, we have now described as the **eighth step**: *'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself. 'Experiencing the whole body, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains*

himself, in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

Alright, we have now described as the **ninth step**: *'Calming the bodily formation, I shall breathe in,' thus he trains himself. 'Calming the bodily formation, I shall breathe out,' thus he trains himself*, in the journey from the Ānāpānasati meditation theme towards the Noble Eightfold Path.

Meritorious devotees, we have undertaken to present today's Dhamma sermon in this way under these nine steps. We undertook to divide the steps in this way for our convenience in giving this sermon. So, you who have listened to this Dhamma, should first commit to this Dhamma by repeatedly recalling it. How? By understanding the manner in which the Blessed Lord Buddha said, "Act thus and thus," through these nine steps, and thinking, contemplating: "I act within this Dhamma in that way. I practice in that way. I train in that way."

Thus, having well committed to this Dhamma, dwelling heedfully within the Dhamma, may they attain this deathless great Nibbāna. May they be liberated from the dreadful, painful, fearful suffering of Saṃsāra!

May the merit of listening to this Dhamma be solely a cause for the realization of the Four Noble Truths! May it be auspicious! May it be a sublime perfecting virtue!
May the Triple Gem be the refuge of all of you!

Saccānaṃ kati lakkhaṇāni: Saccānaṃ dvādasa lakkhaṇāni:

Dukkhasaccassa uppādo paññāyati, vayo paññāyati,
ṭhitānaṃ aññathattaṃ paññāyati.

Samudayasaccassa uppādo paññāyati, vayo paññāyati,
ṭhitassa aññathattaṃ paññāyati.

Maggasaccassa uppādo paññāyati, vayo paññāyati,
ṭhitassa aññathattaṃ paññāyati.

Nirodhasaccassa na uppādo paññāyati, na vayo paññāyati,
na ṭhitassa aññathattaṃ paññāyati.

Saccānaṃ imāni dvādasa lakkhaṇāni.

The characteristics of the Truths:
The Truths have twelve characteristics:

Of the Truth of Suffering, the arising is discerned,
the passing away is discerned,
the change of what is present is discerned.

Of the Truth of the Origin of Suffering, the arising is discerned,
the passing away is discerned,
the change of what is present is discerned.

Of the Truth of the Path, the arising is discerned,
the passing away is discerned,
the change of what is present is discerned.

Of the Truth of Cessation, the arising is not discerned,
the passing away is not discerned.
The change of what is permanently present is not discerned.

These are the twelve characteristics of the Truths.

- Paṭisambhidāmagga Prakaraṇa, Saccakathā -